

Flex Academy landing page design brief

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Design assignment for Product / Brand Designer candidates: a landing page for Flex Academy, timeboxed to 6 to 8 hours over 7 days, unpaid and scoped to fit that time.

Why this assignment

We are launching a new company and this page is its front door. We want to see how you think about conversion, brand and craft when you have real constraints and real assets. Treat it as your first week on the job, not a portfolio piece.

- Role: Product / Brand Designer (landing pages and marketing sites)
- Timebox: 6 to 8 hours of your time, spread over up to 7 days
- Compensation: unpaid assessment, scoped to fit the timebox. We do not expect or reward more hours than that. Depth of thinking beats volume of screens.

Context

The Flex (theflex.global) operates fully furnished, move-in-ready apartments for short and long stays in London, Paris, Lisbon, Berlin, Algiers, Oran and Constantine, with Milan and Cairo coming. It serves travellers, relocating professionals and over 150 corporate housing partners. Tagline: "Flexible Living, Made Easy."

Base360 (base360.ai) is the property management software the founders built to run The Flex, now sold to other short-term rental (STR) operators: channel manager across 130+ platforms, AI pricing, unified guest inbox, cleaning and maintenance, CRM, finance and HR. Tagline: "Run your Short Term Rentals on AI autopilot." Primary CTA: Book a demo.

Both were founded by **Raouf Yousfi** and **Michael Buggy**.

Flex Academy (new) helps people build and scale their own short-term rental company, using the playbook, the systems and the software the founders used to build The Flex. Think of it as the operator's programme: how to source units, structure deals, set up operations, hire, price and grow, taught by people who did it and still do it.

Audience

Design for these three people. Pick one as primary and say which in your Loom.

1. The side-hustler with 1 to 3 units who wants to turn Airbnb income into a company.
2. The operator with 5 to 30 units who is stuck: too much manual work, thin margins, no time to grow.
3. The property professional (agent, developer, landlord) who wants to add an STR arm without learning by trial and error.

They are ambitious, busy, sceptical of "guru" courses, and comparing us against YouTube, cheap online courses and expensive masterminds.

The job of the page

Primary conversion: "Book a free strategy call." A 20 to 30 minute call with the team, qualified by a short form (units today, target, city, budget band). Design the moment of commitment: the CTA, the form or the hand-off to a calendar, and the confirmation state.

Secondary conversion: join the waitlist or get the free "STR scaling checklist" by email, for visitors who are not ready to talk.

Success looks like: a visitor understands in 5 seconds who this is for and what they get, trusts us within 30 seconds, and can act at any point of the scroll without hunting.

Scope

Required:

- Desktop landing page, 1440 px wide, full scroll. One coherent page, not a site.
- Mobile, 390 px wide: the hero and one more section of your choice (the one where you think mobile changes the design the most).
- The CTA flow: button state, form or calendar step, confirmation. Static frames are fine.
- A 1-page design notes frame in Figma (or the Loom alone if you prefer talking): audience choice, page structure, 3 key decisions.

Optional, only inside the timebox:

- Micro-interaction or motion concept for the hero (a few frames or a prototype).
- A dark mode or an alternative art direction for one section.

Out of scope: logo redesign, full brand system, copy for every section, development.

Assets you can use

- Live sites: theflex.global and base360.ai (logos, colours, type, photography, product screenshots, testimonials, city list). You may extend both brands; Flex Academy should feel like a sibling, not a copy. Tell us how you related the three.
- Founder photos and bios: [link to folder], sent within 24 hours of you accepting.
- Proof points you may use as real: [insert: units under management, cities, years operating, guests hosted, team size, Base360 customers]. Anything else you need as proof, use clearly labelled placeholders such as "[X units]".
- Programme structure placeholder (to be refined with the hire): 12 weeks, weekly group session, monthly 1:1 with a founder, operator community, templates and SOPs, Base360 access during the programme. You may propose a better structure in your notes.
- Stock, AI imagery and icon sets: allowed, but mark anything you did not make.

Copy

You do not need to write finished copy. Write real headlines, subheads and CTA labels (no lorem ipsum in those). Body text can be short placeholder sentences that say what the block is for. If you are strong at copy, show it; it counts, but it is not the main thing we score.

Deliverables

1. Figma link with view access (one file). Name frames clearly. Include the design notes frame if you made one.
2. Loom video, 5 minutes maximum, walking the page top to bottom: who it is for, the structure you chose and why, the three decisions you are proudest of, and one thing you would test first after launch.
3. Optional: a paragraph on what you would do with 2 more days.

Send both links to [email] by [date, time zone]. We confirm receipt the same day.

How we evaluate

Every submission is scored on the same grid, then the top ones are discussed together. Each criterion is scored 1 to 5; the weight shows what matters most.

Criterion	Weight	What a 5 looks like
Conversion design	25%	Clear hierarchy, one obvious next step at every scroll depth, trust built before the ask, CTA flow designed end to end, form friction justified.
Visual craft	25%	Type, spacing, colour and imagery form a system. Screens look finished at 100% zoom. Creates the "wow" without hurting readability.
Brand thinking	15%	Reads as a sibling of The Flex and Base360 (shared DNA, own personality). The relationship between the three brands is deliberate and explained.
Audience clarity	15%	A first-time visitor knows in 5 seconds who this is for, what they get and why these founders. Objections of sceptical operators are answered.

Communication (Loom and notes)	10%	Decisions explained with reasons and trade-offs, not adjectives. Stays inside 5 minutes.
Craft under constraints	10%	Mobile frames show real responsive thinking, not shrunken desktop. Components reused sensibly. Timebox respected.

Loses points: generic SaaS templates with the logo swapped, testimonial walls with invented names presented as real, ignoring the mobile frames, a Loom that narrates the screens instead of explaining decisions.

Process and fairness

- Questions: reply to this email any time; we answer within one working day. Asking good questions counts in your favour.
- After submission: we review within 5 working days and invite the shortlist to a 30-minute call with Raouf and Michael to discuss the work.
- Your work stays yours. We will not use or adapt your design unless we hire you or agree a paid engagement first. We will not share it outside the hiring panel.
- Feedback: everyone who submits gets written feedback against the grid above, whether or not we move forward.
- Tools and honesty: use AI tools however you like, but be ready to explain every decision as your own.

Suggested page structure (optional)

You are free to ignore this. It shows the arguments a visitor needs, in the order they usually need them.

1. Hero: the promise, who it is for, primary CTA, one proof element.
2. Proof strip: numbers from The Flex and Base360 (real, sourced from us).
3. The problem: why most STR businesses stall between 3 and 30 units.
4. The method: how the programme works, step by step.
5. Who teaches it: the founders, the company they built, the software they use.
6. What you get: sessions, community, templates, software access.
7. Results: case studies or testimonials (placeholders allowed, labelled).
8. Who it is not for: an honest filter that raises trust and call quality.
9. FAQ: price, time commitment, geography, refund or guarantee.
10. Final CTA: book the call, with the low-friction secondary option beside it.

Thank you for your time. We know unpaid assignments ask a lot, which is why the scope is small and the feedback is guaranteed.